

Ad Astra is the quarterly magazine of the National Space Society (NSS). The name literally means "To the Stars".

History

The magazine came into being following the merger of the L5 Society and the National Space Institute which became the NSS in 1987. The magazine was established in 1989. It is based in Washington DC. Currently, Ad Astra has a quarterly circulation of approximately 52,000 (print and digital).

Imaginova, publisher of Space.com, published Ad Astra from 2005 to 2008. From 2008 until the company closed, the magazine was published by MM Publishing. The magazine was briefly published by Space.com until 2010, then reverted to internal publication by NSS contractors. Since 2017, Rod Pyle has been Editor-in-Chief with Aggie Kobrin serving as the Director of Publications and Publication manager.

Regular columnists include John F. Kross, Rod Pyle, Pascal Lee, Melissa Silva, Jordan Strickler, Jeff Stepp, Frank White (of the Overview Effect), Dale Skran, Nancy Atkinson, Elizabeth Howell, and Leonard David. Casey Suire is the Senior Reviews Editor. The magazine features the artwork of James Vaughan. The Ad Astra staff includes Editor-in-Chief Rod Pyle, Managing Editor Aggie Kobrin, Assistant Editor Melissa Silva, Copy Editor Shaun Kobrin, Contributing Editor John F. Kross, with layout by Bookpress Publishing.

The magazine is typically 68 pages long, but occasionally publishes special editions (such as one on space education in 2023) over 100 pages in length. It is published in print as well as digital editions, and is available by subscription, by membership in the National Space Society, by membership in NASA Federal Credit Union, and in retail channels throughout the U.S. and Canada (primarily bookstores and newsstands).

Awards

Hermes Awards:

Gold Award 2024

MARCOM Awards:

Gold Award 2023

Gold Award 2009

Printing & Graphics Communications Association:

Award of Excellence for 2003, 2002, 2001, 2000, 1999

Best of Category for 2003, 2002

Best Web Printed Piece for 2003

International Association of Business Communicators:

Silver Inkwell Award of Excellence for 2002

References

External links

Official website

NSS official website

Further reading

"National Space Society selects new publisher for Ad Astra magazine; New York City-based MM Publishing Inc. takes over publishing, editing duties in 2008" Archived 2016-11-08 at the Wayback Machine, Press release, November 28, 2007, National Space Society

"National Space Society partners with Space.com to create new online destination for Ad Astra

magazine; appoints Imaginova Corp. publisher of magazine" Archived 2016-11-08 at the Wayback Machine, Press release, January 31, 2005, National Space Society and Imaginova